shut off communications with the rest of the world, arrested the leaders of Solidarity, and imposed martial law.

The crackdown fell short of the military intervention we had warned against, but our intelligence experts established that the entire exercise had been ordered from and orchestrated by Moscow.

A day or two after the crackdown, Al Haig brought me confidential information that the Polish ambassador in Washington, Romuald Spasowski, wanted to defect immediately. Our people managed to spirit him away before the KGB got to him; the ambassador and his wife, daughter, and son-in-law were taken to a safe place.

Two days later, I wrote in the diary,

> [At today's N.S.C. meeting] I took a stand that this may be the last chance in our lifetime to see a change in the Soviet Empire's colonial policy re Eastern Europe. We should take a stand and tell them unless and until martial law is lifted in Poland, the prisoners were released and negotiations resumed between Walesa and the Polish government, we would quarantine the Soviets and Poland with no trade or communications across their borders. Also tell our NATO allies and others to join us in such sanctions or risk an estrangement from us. A TV speech is in the works.

On December 22, Ambassador Spasowski and his wife came to see me in the Oval Office; both had looks of desperation that were mixed with relief. Their faces brightened when I told them I welcomed them to America as genuine Polish patriots. Spasowski said he and his family had been thinking about defecting for several years and had been moving closer and closer to it, then decided to act after the imposition of martial law and crackdown on Solidarity.

It was an emotional meeting for all of us and left me with more disgust than ever for the evil men in the Kremlin who